



Centre for Environment and Agricultural Development (CEAD)

Thavalakuppam, Puducherry, India.



ANNUAL REPORT 2025–2026

Prepared by:

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Thavalakuppam, Puducherry-605007.

Director's Message

It gives me immense pleasure to present the **Annual Report 2025–2026** of the **Centre for Environment and Agricultural Development (CEAD)**. This report reflects our collective efforts, achievements, and commitment towards promoting sustainable agriculture, environmental conservation, rural development, and capacity building among farmers, students, women, and rural youth. During the year, CEAD successfully organized a wide range of training programmes, awareness campaigns, national conferences, and community outreach activities that contributed significantly to agricultural development and environmental sustainability. Our programmes focused on enhancing farmers' knowledge, promoting eco-friendly agricultural practices, encouraging entrepreneurship, and strengthening collaboration among educational institutions, government departments, research organizations, and local communities. One of the major milestones of this year was the successful implementation of the **Agri-Clinic and Agri-Business Centre (ACABC) Training Programme**, which empowered aspiring agri-entrepreneurs with technical knowledge and business management skills. We also organized the **National Campaign on Ashwagandha**, creating awareness on the medicinal importance and cultivation potential of this valuable herbal crop among farming and fisheries communities. Furthermore, the **RECLAIM–2026 National Conference** provided an excellent platform for researchers, academicians, students, and farmers to exchange knowledge on sustainable soil management, vermicomposting, and regenerative agriculture.

CEAD remained committed to nurturing the next generation of agricultural professionals through internship programmes, practical training sessions, and field demonstrations. Awareness programmes on integrated pest management, vegetable cultivation, terrace gardening, agroforestry, and environmental conservation strengthened our mission of promoting climate-resilient and sustainable farming practices. These accomplishments would not have been possible without the dedicated efforts of our faculty members, staff, volunteers, resource persons, collaborating institutions, government agencies, and the wholehearted participation of farmers, students, and community members. I extend my sincere gratitude to all our partners and stakeholders for their unwavering support and valuable contributions throughout the year.

As we move forward, CEAD will continue to expand its initiatives in sustainable agriculture, organic farming, environmental education, rural entrepreneurship, and technology-driven agricultural development. We remain committed to empowering farming communities, conserving natural resources, and contributing meaningfully to the nation's vision of sustainable and inclusive development. I sincerely thank everyone who has supported CEAD in its journey and look forward to your continued cooperation in the years ahead.

With warm regards,



Dr. C. Ganeche
Director, CEAD
Thavalakuppam,
Puducherry, India.



1. About CEAD

Centre for Environment and Agricultural Development (CEAD)

The **Centre for Environment and Agricultural Development (CEAD)** is a non-governmental organization committed to promoting sustainable agriculture, environmental conservation, rural development, and livelihood enhancement through education, research, training, and community outreach. Since its inception, CEAD has worked closely with farmers, students, women, rural youth, government agencies, educational institutions, and research organizations to encourage environmentally responsible and economically viable agricultural practices.



Figure: CEAD Office Building

CEAD serves as a platform for knowledge exchange, capacity building, and technology transfer by organizing training programmes, workshops, awareness campaigns, demonstrations, conferences, and extension activities. The organization is dedicated to empowering farming communities through innovative agricultural technologies, natural resource management, entrepreneurship development, and climate-resilient farming practices. With a multidisciplinary approach, CEAD continues to strengthen partnerships with national and state-level institutions to support sustainable agricultural development and improve the quality of life of rural communities.

1.1 Vision

To become a leading institution in promoting sustainable agriculture, environmental conservation, and rural development by empowering communities through knowledge, innovation, and environmentally responsible practices.

1.2 Mission

- To promote sustainable and climate-resilient agricultural practices.
- To conserve natural resources and protect the environment through community participation.
- To strengthen the livelihood of farmers, women, and rural youth through skill development and entrepreneurship.
- To facilitate research, training, and extension services in agriculture and environmental management.
- To build strong collaborations with government departments, academic institutions, research organizations, and civil society for inclusive rural development.

1.3 Objectives

- Promote sustainable agricultural production systems and organic farming practices.
- Create awareness on environmental conservation, biodiversity, and climate change adaptation.
- Organize capacity-building programmes, workshops, seminars, conferences, and farmer training programmes.
- Encourage Agri-Clinic and Agri-Business entrepreneurship among rural youth.
- Support research, innovation, and technology dissemination in agriculture and allied sectors.
- Enhance the knowledge and practical skills of students through internships, field demonstrations, and experiential learning.
- Strengthen farmer–scientist interaction for effective technology transfer.
- Promote medicinal plants, integrated farming systems, soil health management, and natural farming practices.
- Improve rural livelihoods through community-based development programmes.

1.4 Core Activities

- Farmer Training and Capacity Building Programmes
- Agri-Clinic and Agri-Business Centre (ACABC) Training
- National and State-Level Conferences, Seminars, and Workshops
- Environmental Awareness and Conservation Campaigns
- Organic Farming and Natural Farming Promotion
- Soil Health Management and Vermicomposting Training
- Medicinal Plant Cultivation and Herbal Awareness Programmes
- Internship and Skill Development Programmes for Students
- Women's Empowerment and Rural Entrepreneurship Development
- Community Outreach and Extension Activities
- Agroforestry and Social Forestry Initiatives
- Climate-Smart Agriculture and Sustainable Resource Management

1.5 Major Focus Areas

CEAD focuses on creating sustainable solutions for agriculture and environmental development through integrated programmes in the following areas:

- Sustainable Agriculture and Climate-Resilient Farming
- Organic Farming and Natural Resource Management
- Soil Health Improvement and Vermicomposting Technologies
- Environmental Conservation and Biodiversity Protection
- Agri-Entrepreneurship Development
- Medicinal and Aromatic Plant Promotion
- Farmer Education and Extension Services
- Research, Innovation, and Technology Transfer
- Youth Skill Development and Agricultural Internships
- Women's Empowerment and Community Development
- Water Conservation and Eco-friendly Agricultural Practices
- Institutional Collaboration for Sustainable Rural Development

Through these focus areas, CEAD strives to build resilient farming communities, enhance agricultural productivity, conserve the environment, and contribute towards sustainable socio-economic development.

1.6 Our Team

The success of the Centre for Environment and Agricultural Development (CEAD) is driven by the dedication, expertise, and commitment of its multidisciplinary team. Our professionals work collaboratively to promote sustainable agriculture, environmental conservation, research, training, and community development programmes across diverse sectors.

Sl. No.	Designation	Name
1	Director	Dr. C. Ganeche
2	Programme Coordinator	Mr. J.S. Balaji
3	Project & Research Coordinator	Dr. A. Thamizharasan
4	Training Coordinator	Mr. P. Manikandan
5	Technical Officer	Ms. R. Nathiya
6	Extension Officer	Ms. M. Lakshiya
7	Field Coordinator	Ms. L.J. Kaviya
8	Herbal & Medicinal Plants Coordinator	Mr. R. Murugan
9	Administrative Officer	Ms. B. Sathya
10	Driver / Support Staff	Mr. K. Harikesavan

1.7 Human Resources

- Total Full-Time Staff : 7
- Project Staff : 3
- Technical Experts : 3
- Administrative Staff : 1

- Volunteers : 25
- Internship Students Guided (2025–2026) : 202

Our Strength: CEAD's team combines scientific expertise, field experience, and community engagement to deliver impactful programmes in sustainable agriculture, environmental management, rural entrepreneurship, and capacity building.

2. Agri-Clinic and Agri-Business Centre (ACABC) Training Programme

Duration: 29 September 2025 – 16 November 2025

Valedictory Programme: 17 November 2025

Venue: CEAD Training Centre, Lalitha Nagar, Thavalakuppam, Puducherry

Sponsored by: National Institute of Agricultural Extension Management (MANAGE), Hyderabad, Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers' Welfare, Government of India.

The Centre for Environment and Agricultural Development (CEAD), functioning as a Nodal Training Institute under the Agri-Clinic and Agri-Business Centres (ACABC) Scheme, successfully organized a **45-day ACABC Training Programme** from **29 September 2025 to 16 November 2025**. The programme was conducted to empower unemployed agriculture and allied science graduates with the knowledge, skills, and entrepreneurial competencies required to establish successful agri-based enterprises. The training programme combined classroom instruction, practical demonstrations, field exposure, expert lectures, and business development sessions to provide participants with a comprehensive understanding of modern agriculture and agribusiness management. Experienced scientists, bankers, agricultural experts, and successful entrepreneurs shared their expertise on sustainable farming practices, enterprise planning, financial management, market opportunities, and government support schemes.

A major highlight of the programme was the emphasis on experiential learning through field visits and practical demonstrations. Participants were exposed to innovative agricultural technologies, integrated farming systems, organic farming, vermicomposting, medicinal plant cultivation, value addition, and agribusiness management practices. The programme also guided participants in preparing viable business plans and understanding institutional credit facilities available for agri-enterprises. The valedictory function was held on **17 November 2025** in the presence of distinguished guests from MANAGE, NABARD, the banking sector, and the Government of Puducherry. Certificates were distributed to all successful participants, recognizing the completion of the training programme and encouraging them to establish sustainable agri-enterprises.

2.1 Programme Objectives

- Promote agripreneurship among agriculture and allied science graduates.
- Develop technical and managerial skills required for agri-business establishment.
- Enhance knowledge on sustainable agricultural technologies and enterprise management.

- Facilitate access to institutional credit and government support schemes.
- Encourage self-employment and rural entrepreneurship.

2.2 Major Outcomes

- Enhanced entrepreneurial skills among trainees.
- Improved understanding of sustainable and climate-resilient agricultural practices.
- Development of bankable agri-business project proposals.
- Strengthened linkage between trainees, financial institutions, and technical experts.
- Encouraged participants to establish self-employment ventures in the agricultural sector.

2.3 Programme Highlights

- 45-day intensive residential training programme.
- Technical sessions by scientists and subject experts.
- Practical demonstrations and field visits.
- Entrepreneurship Development and Business Planning.
- Interaction with financial institutions and agri-business professionals.
- Certificate distribution during the valedictory programme.

Photo Gallery



Figure. Screening the unemployed student in 45-Day ACABC Training Programme.



Figure. Inauguration of the 45-Day ACABC Training Programme.



Figure. Classroom session on agripreneurship and business management.

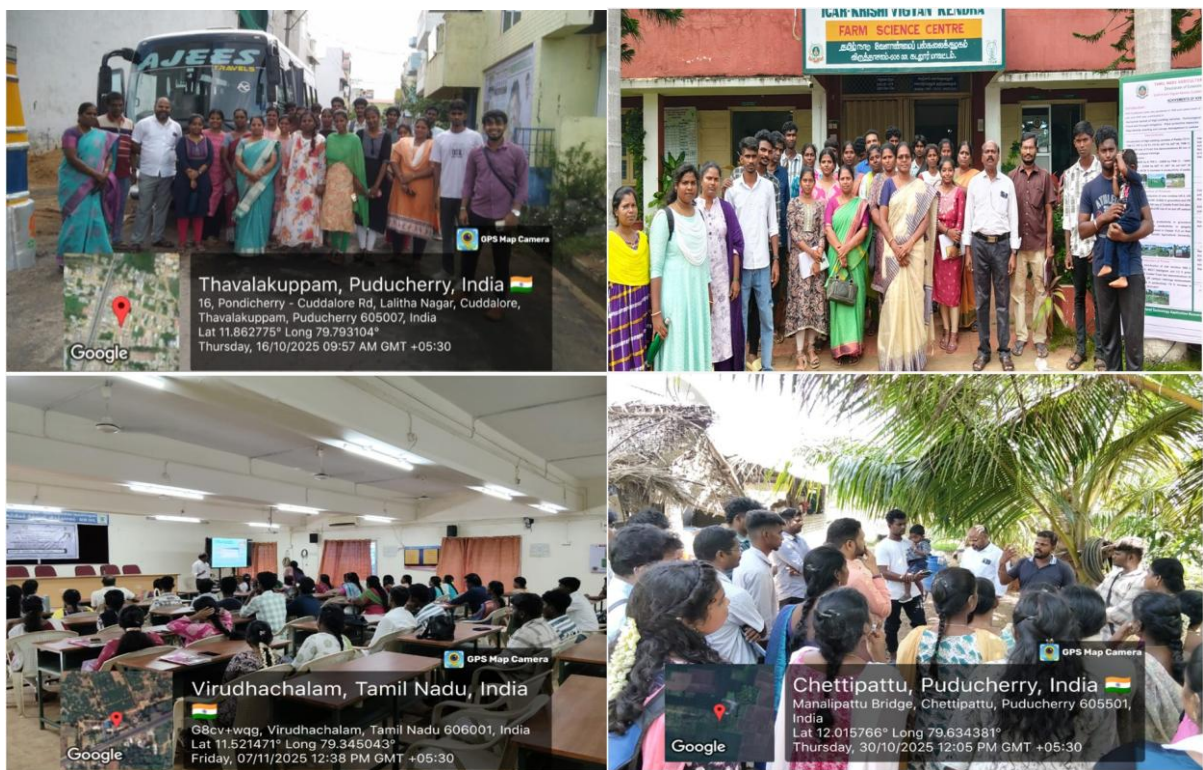


Figure. Field visit and practical exposure to sustainable agricultural practices.



Figure. Valedictory function and certificate distribution held on 17 November 2025.

3. National Campaign on Ashwagandha – A Health Promoter for Fisheries Community of Puducherry Union Territory

The **National Campaign on Ashwagandha – A Health Promoter for Fisheries Community of Puducherry Union Territory** was successfully organized on **27 February 2026** at **K.V.P. Hall, Thavalakuppam, Puducherry** by **Vivekanandha Trust** in association with the **Centre for Environment and Agricultural Development (CEAD)**. The programme was supported by the **National Medicinal Plants Board (NMPB), Ministry of AYUSH, and Government of India**. The campaign was conducted with the objective of creating awareness on the medicinal, nutritional, and economic importance of **Ashwagandha (Withania somnifera)** and promoting its cultivation as a sustainable livelihood opportunity for farmers and the fisheries community. The event brought together scientists, medical professionals, government officials, farmers, students, and members of the public to share knowledge on medicinal plant cultivation, organic farming, sustainable agriculture, and market opportunities, thereby strengthening community awareness and institutional collaboration.

3.1 Programme Objectives

- To create awareness about the medicinal and therapeutic benefits of Ashwagandha.
- To promote the cultivation of medicinal plants in coastal and marginal farming areas.
- To encourage organic and sustainable agricultural practices.
- To improve the livelihood opportunities of farmers and fisheries communities.
- To strengthen linkages between research institutions, government departments, and farming communities.

3.2 Resource Persons

The programme featured technical presentations by eminent scientists, medical experts, and government officials, including:

- **Dr. P. Manivel**, Principal Scientist & Head, ICAR–NIRCA
- **Dr. K. Sadagopan**, Medical Officer (Siddha)
- **Dr. R. Sridharan**, Senior Chief Medical Officer (Siddha)
- **Mr. S. Kumaravelu**, Deputy Director of Agriculture
- **Mr. I. Joseph Albert**, Secretary, Pondicherry Market Committee

The technical sessions covered Ashwagandha cultivation practices, medicinal applications, sustainable farming techniques, organic agriculture, value addition, and market opportunities.

3.3 Programme Outcomes

- Increased awareness on the health and medicinal importance of Ashwagandha.
- Enhanced knowledge on scientific cultivation practices for medicinal plants.
- Strengthened understanding of organic farming and sustainable agriculture.
- Improved interaction between researchers, extension agencies, and farming communities.

- Encouraged participants to adopt medicinal plant cultivation as an additional source of income.

3.4 Programme Impact

The campaign created significant awareness among farmers, students, and fisheries communities regarding the cultivation and utilization of Ashwagandha. Participants gained practical knowledge on medicinal plant production, sustainable farming methods, and market opportunities, thereby supporting livelihood diversification and environmental sustainability. The programme further strengthened institutional collaboration for promoting medicinal plant cultivation and community-based agricultural development in Puducherry.

Photo Gallery



Figure: Inaugural Session and Honouring of Dignitaries



Figure: Farmer, students Interaction and Awareness Session



Figure: Certificate Distribution Ceremony

4. National Conference on Recycling and Earthworm-based Composting for Land Improvement and Agricultural Management (RECLAIM–2026).

The Centre for Environment and Agricultural Development (CEAD), in association with the Pondicherry Institute of Agricultural Sciences (PIAS), successfully organized the **National Conference on “Recycling and Earthworm-based Composting for Land Improvement and Agricultural Management (RECLAIM–2026)”** on **13 March 2026** at K.V.P. Mahal, Thavalakuppam, and Puducherry. The conference was conducted with the support of the **Department of Science, Technology & Environment (DSTE)** and the **Puducherry Council for Science and Technology (PCST), Government of Puducherry**. The conference served as a national platform for academicians, scientists, researchers, students, extension professionals, and farmers to exchange knowledge and promote sustainable agricultural practices through soil restoration and organic waste recycling.

4.1 Introduction

The RECLAIM–2026 National Conference was organized with the objective of promoting sustainable soil management through recycling technologies and earthworm-based composting. The conference highlighted innovative approaches to soil restoration, organic farming, vermicomposting, and climate-resilient agriculture. Through expert lectures, technical sessions, scientific presentations, and interactive discussions, the programme encouraged collaboration among researchers, educational institutions, farmers, and policymakers for achieving sustainable agricultural development.

4.2 Conference Objectives

- Promote sustainable soil management and regenerative agriculture.
- Create awareness on vermicomposting and vermiwash technologies.
- Encourage scientific recycling of organic waste for soil improvement.
- Facilitate knowledge exchange among scientists, researchers, students, and farmers.
- Promote eco-friendly agricultural technologies for climate-resilient farming.
- Strengthen collaboration between academic institutions, government agencies, and farming communities.

4.3 Chief Guests and Dignitaries

The inaugural session was graced by **Prof. Sultan Ahmed Ismail**, Managing Director, Ecoscience Research Foundation, Chennai, who delivered the keynote address on the importance of earthworms in restoring soil fertility and environmental sustainability. The conference was presided over by **Dr. C. Ganeche**, Chairman, Pondicherry Institute of Agricultural Sciences (PIAS), who emphasized the integration of scientific innovations with traditional agricultural knowledge for sustainable rural development. Distinguished scientists, academicians, researchers, and agricultural experts also participated and shared their valuable experiences with the delegates.

4.4 Technical Sessions

The conference featured a series of technical sessions delivered by eminent scientists and subject experts on emerging issues in sustainable agriculture. The sessions covered vermicomposting technologies, soil nutrient management, microbial interactions, organic farming, regenerative agriculture, and climate-smart agricultural practices. Participants benefited from expert lectures, research presentations, and interactive discussions that emphasized practical applications and scientific innovations for improving soil health and agricultural productivity.

4.5 Awards and Recognition

To encourage excellence in agricultural research and innovation, several awards were presented during the conference, including **Best Abstract Award, Best Oral Presentation Award, Best Poster Presentation Award, Young Scientist Award, and Innovative Research Award**. Outstanding farmers and institutions working towards sustainable agriculture and environmental conservation were also recognized for their valuable contributions.

4.6 Conference Outcomes

The conference successfully enhanced awareness on sustainable soil management, vermicomposting, and environmentally friendly agricultural technologies. Participants gained valuable scientific knowledge and practical insights into regenerative agriculture and organic waste recycling. The event strengthened networking among researchers, students, government agencies, and farming communities while encouraging the adoption of eco-friendly farming practices for long-term agricultural sustainability.

4.7 Future Recommendations

- Promote large-scale adoption of vermicomposting and organic waste recycling technologies.
- Strengthen collaborative research on soil health restoration and climate-resilient agriculture.
- Organize regular farmer training programmes and scientific workshops on regenerative agriculture.
- Encourage participation of students and young researchers in sustainable agriculture initiatives.
- Develop institutional partnerships to promote eco-friendly farming technologies and environmental conservation.

Photo Gallery



Figure. Inaugural Lamp Lighting Ceremony with Chief Guests.



Figure: Honouring the Invited Guests



Figure. Release of the RECLAIM-2026 Souvenir and Book of Abstracts.





Figure. Technical Session by Eminent Scientists and Invited Speakers.



Figure. Delegates, Students, and Participants during the Conference.



Figure. Distribution of Awards and Recognition to Outstanding Participants.



Figure. Group Photograph with Chief Guests, Scientists, Organizing Committee, and Participants.

5. World Soil Day Celebration and Social Forestry Initiative

The **Centre for Environment and Agricultural Development (CEAD)** observed **World Soil Day** on **05 December 2025** with the theme of promoting **soil health, environmental sustainability, and climate-resilient agriculture**. The programme was organized at the CEAD campus to create awareness among students, farmers, and the local community about the importance of conserving soil resources for sustainable agricultural production and environmental protection. As part of the celebration, CEAD strengthened its **Social Forestry and Agroforestry Development Programme** by undertaking tree plantation activities and creating awareness on biodiversity conservation. Participants actively engaged in plantation drives and learned the importance of integrating trees into agricultural landscapes to improve soil fertility, conserve natural resources, and enhance ecological balance.

5.1 Importance of World Soil Day

Healthy soil is the foundation of sustainable agriculture and food security. World Soil Day serves as a global platform to emphasize the importance of protecting soil resources from degradation, erosion, pollution, and nutrient depletion. The programme highlighted the role of healthy soils in increasing agricultural productivity, conserving biodiversity, improving water retention, mitigating climate change, and ensuring sustainable livelihoods for farming communities.

5.2 Activities Conducted

During the celebration, several awareness and field-based activities were organized to promote soil conservation and environmental stewardship.

- World Soil Day awareness programme for students and farmers.
- Tree plantation under the Social Forestry and Agroforestry Development Programme.
- Demonstration on the importance of soil health management.
- Awareness sessions on biodiversity conservation and ecosystem restoration.
- Discussion on sustainable agricultural practices and climate-resilient farming.
- Student participation in environmental conservation activities.

5.3 Tree Plantation Initiative

Tree saplings were planted across the CEAD campus to strengthen green cover and promote sustainable land management. The plantation programme encouraged students and staff to actively participate in environmental conservation while highlighting the ecological benefits of trees in improving soil fertility, reducing erosion, enhancing carbon sequestration, and supporting biodiversity.

5.4 Soil Health Awareness

An interactive awareness session was conducted to educate participants on the importance of maintaining healthy soils through organic farming, vermicomposting, integrated nutrient

management, and conservation agriculture. Students and farmers were encouraged to adopt eco-friendly agricultural practices that improve soil productivity while protecting natural resources for future generations.

5.5 Agroforestry Development

CEAD continued its commitment to sustainable agriculture by promoting agroforestry practices that integrate trees with agricultural crops. The initiative emphasized the long-term benefits of agroforestry in enhancing soil fertility, improving farm resilience, conserving water resources, and supporting climate-smart agricultural systems. The programme reinforced CEAD's vision of promoting environmentally sustainable and economically viable farming practices.

5.6 Programme Impact

The World Soil Day celebration significantly enhanced awareness among students, farmers, and the local community regarding the importance of soil conservation, tree plantation, and sustainable land management. The initiative encouraged greater community participation in environmental protection and strengthened CEAD's commitment to promoting ecological sustainability through education, outreach, and practical field activities.

Photo Gallery



Figure. Social Forestry and Agroforestry plantation at the CEAD campus.

6. Farmers' Day Celebration

The **Centre for Environment and Agricultural Development (CEAD)** celebrated **National Farmers' Day** on **23 December 2025** at the **CEAD Campus, Thavalakuppam, and Puducherry**, to honour the invaluable contribution of farmers towards ensuring food security, sustainable agriculture, and rural development. The programme brought together farmers, agricultural professionals, students, and extension personnel to recognize the dedication of the farming community and promote sustainable agricultural practices. The celebration provided an excellent platform for interaction between farmers and agricultural experts, enabling participants to exchange experiences, discuss field-level challenges, and explore innovative farming technologies. Technical discussions focused on sustainable agriculture, soil health management, organic farming, integrated farming systems, and government support programmes that can enhance agricultural productivity and improve rural livelihoods.

6.1 Importance of National Farmers' Day

National Farmers' Day is observed every year on **23 December** to commemorate the birth anniversary of **Chaudhary Charan Singh**, the fifth Prime Minister of India, in recognition of his remarkable contribution to the welfare of farmers and the agricultural sector. The celebration highlights the vital role of farmers in ensuring food security, conserving natural resources, and supporting the nation's economy.

6.2 Farmer Interaction

An interactive session encouraged farmers to share their experiences, innovative farming practices, and challenges faced in agriculture. Agricultural experts provided guidance on climate-resilient farming, organic agriculture, integrated nutrient management, and resource conservation, creating a valuable platform for mutual learning and knowledge exchange.

6.3 Knowledge Sharing

Experts shared practical knowledge on sustainable farming technologies, soil fertility improvement, vermicomposting, natural farming, crop diversification, and government agricultural schemes. The programme encouraged farmers to adopt eco-friendly agricultural practices and modern technologies for improving productivity and ensuring long-term sustainability.

6.4 Programme Impact

The Farmers' Day celebration strengthened the partnership between CEAD and the farming community by promoting scientific agriculture, sustainable farming practices, and continuous knowledge exchange. The programme motivated farmers to adopt innovative technologies while reinforcing CEAD's commitment to supporting agricultural development and rural prosperity.

Photo Gallery



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முரசு

அக்ரி கணேஷ் ஃபவுண்டேஷன் சார்பில் தேசிய விவசாயிகள் தின கொண்டாட்டம்



தவளக்குப்பத்தில் உள்ள அக்ரி கணேஷ் பவுண்டேஷன், புதுச்சேரி வேளாண் அறிவியல் கல்லூரியின் சார்பாக தேசிய விவசாயிகள் தினம் கொண்டாடப்பட்டது.

புதுச்சேரி, டிச. 24-
புதுச்சேரி தவளக்குப்பத்தில் உள்ள அக்ரி கணேஷ் பவுண்டேஷன் மற்றும் புதுச்சேரி வேளாண் அறிவியல் கல்லூரியின் சார்பாக தேசிய விவசாயிகள் தினம் கொண்டாடப்பட்டது.
நிகழ்ச்சிக்கு அக்ரி கணேஷ் பவுண்டேஷன் மற்றும் புதுச்சேரி வேளாண் அறிவியல் கல்லூரியின் நிறுவனர் அக்ரி கணேஷ் தலைமை தாங்கி தவளக்குப்பம், வேளாண் அலுவலர் தண்டபாணி முன்னிலை வகித்தார். முன்னதாக கல்லூரியின் உதவி பேராசிரியர் மணிகண்டன் அனைவரையும் வரவேற்று பேசினார். மேலும் CIDA நிறுவனத்தின் முதன்மை

ஆலோசகர் பாலாஜி நோக்ககரை வழங்கினார். நிகழ்ச்சியில் ஆண்டியார் பாணையம், தவளக்குப்பம், சிவனார்புரம் பகுதி களை சேர்ந்த விவசாயிகள் பங்கேற்றனர். தொடர்ந்து கல்லூரியில் உள்ள பண்ணையில் மரக்கன்றுகள் நடப்பட்டது. ஏற்பாடுகளை கல்லூரி ஆசிரியர்கள், மாணவர்கள் செய்திருந்தனர். கல்லூரி முதல்வர் தமிழரசன் நன்றி கூறினார்.

னார். நிறப்பு அழைப்பான ராக பங்கேற்ற தவளக்குப்பம் வேளாண் அலுவலர் தண்டபாணி பேசுகையில், அரசின் வேளாண் நலத் திட்டங்களையும், விவசாய கடன்-ஆடைய, விவசாய காப்புத் திட்டம் போன்ற திட்டங்களை பற்றி விவசாயிகளுக்கு எடுத்துரைத்து விவசாயிகளை பாராட்டி பேசினார்.
நிகழ்ச்சியில் பங்கேற்ற அனைத்து விவசாயிகளுக்கும் மரக்கன்றுகள் வழங்கப்பட்டதுடன், உலகிற்கே உணவளிக்கும் விவசாயிகளுக்கு நன்றியின் அடையாளமாக உணவும் வழங்கப்பட்டது. மேலும் கல்லூரியில் உள்ள பண்ணையில் மரக்கன்றுகள் நடப்பட்டன.

தேசிய விவசாயிகள் தினம்

புதுச்சேரி, டிச. 24-
தவளக்குப்பம் அக்ரி கணேஷ் பவுண்டேஷன் மற்றும் புதுச்சேரி வேளாண் அறிவியல் கல்லூரி சார்பில், தேசிய விவசாயிகள் தினம் தவளக்குப்பத்தில் கொண்டாடப்பட்டது.
அக்ரி கணேஷ் பவுண்டேஷன் மற்றும் புதுச்சேரி வேளாண் அறிவியல் கல்லூரியின் நிறுவனர் அக்ரி கணேஷ் தலைமை தாங்கினார். உதவி பேராசிரியர் மணிகண்டன் வரவேற்றார். தவளக்குப்பம் வேளாண் அலுவலர் தண்டபாணி முன்னிலை வகித்தார்.

உதவி பேராசிரியை நதியா தொகுத்து வழங்கினார். சி.இ.ஏ.டி., நிறுவனத்தின் முதன்மை ஆலோசகர் பரலாஜி நோக்ககரையார் நினார்.
நிகழ்ச்சியில் ஆண்டியார் பாணையம், தவளக்குப்பம், சிவனார்புரம் பகுதி களை சேர்ந்த விவசாயிகள் பங்கேற்றனர். தொடர்ந்து கல்லூரியில் உள்ள பண்ணையில் மரக்கன்றுகள் நடப்பட்டது. ஏற்பாடுகளை கல்லூரி ஆசிரியர்கள், மாணவர்கள் செய்திருந்தனர். கல்லூரி முதல்வர் தமிழரசன் நன்றி கூறினார்.



Figure. Farmers participating, Knowledge-sharing session with farmers and agricultural experts in the National Farmers' Day celebration.

7. Agricultural Students' Educational Visit and Internship Programme

The **Centre for Environment and Agricultural Development (CEAD)** successfully organized an **Educational Visit and Internship Programme** for the students of the **Agricultural College and Research Institute, Vazhavachanur, Tamil Nadu Agricultural University (TNAU), Thiruvannamalai District**, during the period from **07 December 2025 to 09 February 2026**. The programme was designed to provide experiential learning and practical exposure to sustainable agriculture, environmental conservation, and rural development initiatives implemented by CEAD. Throughout the programme, students actively participated in classroom lectures, practical demonstrations, and field-based learning activities covering organic farming, vermicomposting, medicinal plant cultivation, soil health management, integrated farming systems, and sustainable agricultural practices. The training enabled students to bridge the gap between academic knowledge and practical field applications while enhancing their technical and professional competencies. The internship programme also provided opportunities for students to interact with agricultural experts and field professionals, allowing them to gain valuable insights into extension activities, community development programmes, and environmentally sustainable farming technologies. At the successful completion of the programme, **Internship Completion Certificates** were distributed to all participating students in recognition of their active participation and successful completion of the training. The programme significantly strengthened the academic collaboration between **Tamil Nadu Agricultural University** and **CEAD**, while reinforcing CEAD's commitment to promoting experiential education, skill development, and capacity building among future agricultural professionals.

7.1 Programme Highlights

- **Programme Duration:** 07 December 2025 – 09 February 2026
- **Participating Institution:** Agricultural College and Research Institute, Vazhavachanur, Tamil Nadu Agricultural University (TNAU), Thiruvannamalai District
- **Programme Components:** Orientation, Classroom Training, Practical Demonstrations, Field Visits, Experiential Learning, Report Preparation, and Certificate Distribution
- **Major Training Areas:** Organic Farming, Vermicomposting, Soil Health Management, Medicinal Plants, Agroforestry, Integrated Farming Systems, Environmental Conservation, and Rural Extension
- **Beneficiaries:** Undergraduate Agriculture Students

7.2 Programme Outcomes

- Enhanced practical knowledge and technical skills of agriculture students.
- Improved understanding of sustainable and climate-resilient agricultural practices.
- Strengthened experiential learning through hands-on field demonstrations.
- Promoted collaboration between CEAD and Tamil Nadu Agricultural University.

- Developed students' confidence in agricultural extension, research, and rural development activities.
- Encouraged students to apply scientific knowledge for sustainable farming and environmental conservation.

Photo Gallery



Figure. Agricultural students participating in the orientation programme at CEAD.



Figure. Practical training on sustainable agriculture



Figure. Students during field demonstrations and experiential learning activities.

8. Pongal Celebration

The **Centre for Environment and Agricultural Development (CEAD)** celebrated the **Pongal Festival** on **13 January 2026** at the **CEAD Campus, Thavalakuppam, Puducherry**, with great enthusiasm and traditional spirit. The celebration brought together CEAD staff members, volunteers, internship students, and well-wishers to honour the rich cultural heritage of Tamil Nadu and express gratitude to nature, farmers, and the agricultural community for their invaluable contribution to food production and sustainable livelihoods. The celebration commenced with the traditional **Pongal cooking ceremony**, symbolizing prosperity, abundance, and thanksgiving. Staff members and volunteers actively participated in preparing the traditional Pongal in earthen pots, followed by offering prayers to the Sun God as a mark of respect for a successful harvest season. The campus was beautifully decorated with colourful **Kolam (Rangoli)** designs, sugarcane, turmeric plants, and other traditional festive decorations, creating a vibrant and festive atmosphere.

As part of the celebration, the Director and senior officials conveyed their Pongal greetings and emphasized the importance of preserving agricultural traditions, promoting sustainable farming practices, and recognizing the hard work and dedication of farmers. The event also highlighted the cultural significance of Pongal as a festival that strengthens unity, teamwork, and community participation. Traditional cultural activities and interactive games were organized for staff members, volunteers, and internship students, fostering team spirit and strengthening interpersonal relationships within the organization. The participants enthusiastically engaged in the celebrations, making the event memorable and reinforcing the values of cooperation, harmony, and cultural diversity. The Pongal celebration concluded with the distribution of traditional festive meals and sweets to all participants. The programme reflected CEAD's commitment to preserving Indian cultural traditions while promoting respect for agriculture, farmers, and the environment. The event also provided an opportunity for staff and volunteers to celebrate together, strengthening the bond among members of the organization and creating a positive and inclusive work environment.



Figure. CEAD staff and volunteers participating in the traditional Pongal cooking ceremony.

9. One-Day Internship Programme for Bharathidasan Government College for Women, Puducherry

The **Centre for Environment and Agricultural Development (CEAD)** successfully organized a **One-Day Internship Programme** on **11 February 2026** for the students of **Bharathidasan Government College for Women, Puducherry**. The programme aimed to provide practical exposure to sustainable agriculture, environmental conservation, and rural development through experiential learning and hands-on training. The programme commenced with an orientation session introducing the vision, mission, and key activities of CEAD. Students were familiarized with the organization's initiatives in sustainable agriculture, organic farming, environmental protection, rural entrepreneurship, and community development. The orientation emphasized the importance of integrating theoretical knowledge with practical field experience to prepare students for future careers in agriculture and allied sectors. Technical sessions covered a wide range of topics, including organic farming, vermicomposting, soil health management, medicinal and aromatic plant cultivation, integrated farming systems, agroforestry, and climate-smart agriculture. Experts explained the scientific principles and practical applications of these technologies, enabling students to understand their role in sustainable agricultural development.

As part of the internship, students visited the CEAD demonstration units, including the vermicompost production unit, herbal garden, nursery, and organic farming plots. Hands-on demonstrations on vermicompost production, organic input preparation, and medicinal plant cultivation provided valuable practical experience and enhanced their technical skills. Interactive discussions with agricultural experts encouraged students to explore innovative farming practices, higher education opportunities, and careers in agricultural extension and rural development. The programme concluded with a feedback session, during which participants shared their learning experiences and appreciated the practical exposure provided by CEAD. **Certificates of Participation** were distributed to all students in recognition of their successful completion of the internship programme. The internship significantly enhanced the students' understanding of sustainable agriculture, environmental management, and rural development while strengthening the academic collaboration between **Bharathidasan Government College for Women, Puducherry**, and **CEAD**. The programme reflected CEAD's continued commitment to promoting experiential learning, capacity building, and skill development among young learners, preparing them to contribute effectively to sustainable agricultural and environmental development.

9.1 Programme Highlights

- **Date:** 11th February 2026
- **Participating Institution:** Bharathidasan Government College for Women, Puducherry
- **Programme Type:** One-Day Internship Programme

- **Major Training Areas:** Organic Farming, Vermicomposting, Soil Health Management, Medicinal Plants, Agroforestry, Environmental Conservation, and Sustainable Agriculture
- **Beneficiaries:** Undergraduate Students

9.2 Programme Outcomes

- Enhanced practical knowledge of sustainable agriculture and environmental conservation.
- Improved understanding of modern agricultural technologies through field demonstrations.
- Developed technical skills through hands-on learning activities.
- Encouraged students to pursue careers in agriculture, environmental sciences, and rural development.
- Strengthened institutional collaboration between CEAD and Bharathidasan Government College for Women.



Figure. Students participating in Technical lecture and practical demonstrations at the CEAD demonstration units.



Figure. Group photo with Student, faculty members and agricultural experts.

10. International Women's Day Celebration

CEAD celebrated **International Women's Day** on **08 March 2026** at the **CEAD Campus, Thavalakuppam, Puducherry**, with great enthusiasm and appreciation for the remarkable contributions of women in agriculture, environmental conservation, education, and community development. The celebration brought together CEAD staff members, volunteers, internship students, and invited guests to recognize the achievements, leadership, and resilience of women in building sustainable communities. The programme commenced with a welcome address highlighting the significance of International Women's Day and the important role of women in promoting sustainable agriculture, rural development, and environmental protection. The Director of CEAD conveyed his greetings and emphasized the need to create equal opportunities for women through education, skill development, entrepreneurship, and leadership.

As part of the celebration, motivational talks and interactive sessions were conducted to inspire women to actively participate in agricultural entrepreneurship, environmental conservation, and community development initiatives. Participants also shared their experiences and discussed the challenges and opportunities faced by women in achieving social and economic empowerment. To encourage teamwork and strengthen interpersonal relationships, various cultural programmes, fun activities, and interactive games were organized for staff members, volunteers, and internship students. The celebration created a joyful atmosphere and promoted unity, mutual respect, and collaboration among all participants. The programme concluded with the distribution of appreciation gifts and refreshments to all participants. The celebration reflected CEAD's commitment to promoting **gender equality, women's empowerment, and inclusive development**, while recognizing the invaluable role of women in achieving sustainable agricultural growth and environmental sustainability.

10.1 Programme Highlights

- Celebration of International Women's Day – **08 March 2026**
- Special address on women's empowerment and leadership.
- Motivational and interactive sessions.
- Cultural programmes and team-building activities.
- Appreciation of women staff members and volunteers.
- Distribution of gifts and refreshments.

10.2 Programme Impact

The International Women's Day celebration strengthened the spirit of unity, confidence, and empowerment among women staff members, volunteers, and students. The programme inspired participants to contribute actively towards sustainable agriculture, environmental conservation, and community development while reinforcing CEAD's commitment to gender equality and inclusive growth.



Figure. *Appreciation of women staff members and group photograph with all participants.*

11. Awareness and Capacity Building Programmes

The **Centre for Environment and Agricultural Development (CEAD)** successfully organized an **Awareness and Capacity Building Programme** on **13 April 2026** for the **Alumni of the Diploma in Agriculture and Diploma in Horticulture of the Pondicherry Institute of Agricultural Sciences (PIAS)**. The programme was conducted with the objective of strengthening participants' technical knowledge and practical skills in sustainable agriculture while promoting environmentally friendly farming technologies. The programme focused on key themes such as **Integrated Pest Management (IPM)**, **Vegetable Cultivation**, and **Terrace Gardening**, providing participants with practical knowledge on eco-friendly crop production technologies, organic farming, soil health management, and climate-resilient agricultural practices. Through interactive lectures, practical demonstrations, and technical discussions, the alumni were introduced to scientific methods of crop production, biological pest management, organic nutrient management, and efficient utilization of natural resources. Special emphasis was placed on reducing the indiscriminate use of chemical pesticides through the adoption of **Integrated Pest Management (IPM)** practices. Participants learned about pest surveillance, biological control agents, botanical pesticides, pheromone traps, sticky traps, and integrated crop protection strategies for sustainable agricultural production. The sessions also covered improved vegetable cultivation techniques, including nursery management, seed treatment, transplanting, irrigation, nutrient management, and crop maintenance for enhancing productivity and quality.

The **Terrace Gardening** session encouraged participants to establish household gardens for producing fresh and nutritious vegetables using limited urban spaces. Practical demonstrations included container selection, potting media preparation, organic manure application, kitchen waste composting, irrigation management, and cultivation techniques suitable for home gardens. The programme emphasized the importance of urban agriculture

in improving household nutrition, environmental sustainability, and food security. The programme concluded with an interactive discussion, during which the PIAS alumni shared their experiences and clarified technical queries with the resource persons. The training significantly enhanced participants' knowledge of sustainable farming practices and encouraged the adoption of environmentally responsible agricultural technologies. The programme also strengthened the continuing relationship between **PIAS** and **CEAD**, reflecting the organization's commitment to agricultural extension, alumni engagement, and capacity building for sustainable rural development.

Objectives

- To create awareness on sustainable agricultural technologies.
- To promote eco-friendly Integrated Pest Management (IPM) practices.
- To enhance knowledge on scientific vegetable cultivation techniques.
- To encourage terrace gardening for household nutrition and urban agriculture.
- To strengthen the technical capacity of PIAS diploma alumni in sustainable agriculture.

Major Outcomes

- Increased awareness of sustainable and climate-resilient farming practices.
- Improved understanding of Integrated Pest Management technologies.
- Enhanced practical knowledge of vegetable cultivation and terrace gardening.
- Encouraged the adoption of organic and environmentally friendly farming methods.
- Strengthened the professional relationship between PIAS alumni and CEAD through technical capacity-building initiatives.



Figure1. PIAS Diploma Alumni participating in the Awareness and Capacity Building Programme on **Integrated Pest Management (IPM), Vegetable Cultivation, and Terrace Gardening** conducted by CEAD on **13 April 2026**.

12. Achievements of CEAD (2025–2026)

During the financial year **2025–2026**, the **Centre for Environment and Agricultural Development (CEAD)** continued its commitment to sustainable agriculture, environmental conservation, agricultural education, and rural development through a series of impactful programmes and collaborative initiatives. The organization successfully strengthened its role as a leading institution in capacity building, agricultural extension, research promotion, and community outreach.

12.1 Major Achievements

- Successfully organized the **National Conference on “Recycling and Earthworm-based Composting for Land Improvement and Agricultural Management (RECLAIM–2026)”**, bringing together scientists, academicians, researchers, students, and farmers from across the country.
- Successfully conducted the **Agri-Clinics and Agri-Business Centres (ACABC) Training Programme**, empowering aspiring agripreneurs with entrepreneurial and technical skills for sustainable agricultural enterprises.
- Associated with the **National Campaign on Ashwagandha – A Health Promoter for Fisheries Community of Puducherry Union Territory**, supported by the **National Medicinal Plants Board (NMPB)**, **Ministry of AYUSH**, and **Government of India**.
- Organized **World Soil Day Celebration** with tree plantation, soil health awareness programmes, and agroforestry initiatives to promote environmental sustainability and biodiversity conservation.
- Celebrated **National Farmers' Day** by recognizing farmers' contributions and promoting knowledge sharing on sustainable and climate-resilient agricultural practices.
- Conducted **Educational Visits, Internship Programmes, and Experiential Learning** for students from agricultural and higher educational institutions, strengthening practical learning and professional skills.
- Successfully completed a **Long-Term Internship Programme** for students of the **Agricultural College and Research Institute, Vazhavachanur, Tamil Nadu Agricultural University (TNAU)**, providing practical exposure to sustainable agriculture and rural development.
- Organized a **One-Day Internship Programme** for students of **Bharathidasan Government College for Women, Puducherry**, focusing on sustainable agriculture, environmental conservation, and skill development.
- Conducted **Awareness and Capacity Building Programmes on Integrated Pest Management (IPM), Vegetable Cultivation, and Terrace Gardening** for **PIAS Diploma Alumni**, promoting environmentally friendly farming technologies.
- Celebrated **Pongal Festival** and **International Women's Day**, encouraging cultural values, teamwork, women's empowerment, and organizational unity.
- Strengthened institutional collaboration with **Pondicherry Institute of Agricultural Sciences (PIAS)**, educational institutions, government departments, scientists, and

development organizations for promoting sustainable agriculture and community development.

- Promoted **Organic Farming, Vermicomposting, Soil Health Management, Agroforestry, Medicinal Plant Cultivation, Environmental Awareness, and Climate-Resilient Agriculture** through training programmes, demonstrations, and extension activities.
- Continued to provide technical guidance, agricultural extension services, and capacity-building support for students, farmers, women, youth, and rural communities.

12.2 CEAD at a Glance (2025–2026)

- National Conference Successfully Organized
- ACABC Training Programme Conducted
- National Awareness Campaign Supported
- Educational and Internship Programmes Organized
- Student Capacity Building Initiatives Strengthened
- Farmers' Training and Extension Activities Conducted
- World Soil Day and Environmental Programmes Implemented
- Sustainable Agriculture and Organic Farming Promoted
- Women's Empowerment and Community Development Activities Conducted
- Institutional Partnerships and Government Collaboration Strengthened
- Environmental Conservation and Agroforestry Initiatives Expanded
- Commitment to Sustainable Rural Development Reinforced

13. Partnerships and Institutional Collaborations

The **Centre for Environment and Agricultural Development (CEAD)** strongly believes that collaborative partnerships are essential for promoting sustainable agriculture, environmental conservation, research, education, and rural development. During **2025–2026**, CEAD continued to strengthen its institutional network by working closely with government organizations, academic institutions, research organizations, development agencies, and non-governmental organizations. These collaborations enabled the successful implementation of training programmes, awareness campaigns, conferences, capacity-building initiatives, and community development activities.

13.1 Major Institutional Partners

13.1.1 National Institute of Agricultural Extension Management (MANAGE)

CEAD continued its association with the **National Institute of Agricultural Extension Management (MANAGE), Hyderabad**, as a **Nodal Training Institute (NTI)** for implementing the **Agri-Clinics and Agri-Business Centres (ACABC) Scheme**. This partnership supported entrepreneurship development and capacity building among aspiring agripreneurs through structured training programmes.

13.1.2 National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)

CEAD collaborated with **NABARD** in promoting rural entrepreneurship, agricultural development, skill enhancement, and sustainable livelihood initiatives. The partnership supported programmes aimed at strengthening rural communities and encouraging agricultural enterprise development.

13.1.3 Pondicherry Institute of Agricultural Sciences (PIAS)

CEAD maintained a strong academic partnership with the **Pondicherry Institute of Agricultural Sciences (PIAS)** by jointly organizing conferences, awareness programmes, student internships, educational visits, and capacity-building initiatives. The collaboration strengthened experiential learning and agricultural education while promoting sustainable farming technologies.

13.1.4 Vivekanandha Trust

CEAD partnered with **Vivekanandha Trust** in organizing the **National Campaign on Ashwagandha – A Health Promoter for Fisheries Community of Puducherry Union Territory**, supported by the **National Medicinal Plants Board (NMPB), Ministry of AYUSH, and Government of India**. The collaboration promoted awareness on medicinal plants, public health, and sustainable cultivation practices.

13.1.5 Puducherry Council for Science and Technology (PCST)

CEAD collaborated with the **Puducherry Council for Science and Technology (PCST)** for the successful organization of the **RECLAIM–2026 National Conference**, encouraging scientific research, innovation, and sustainable environmental management.

13.1.6 Department of Science, Technology & Environment (DSTE), Government of Puducherry

The **Department of Science, Technology & Environment (DSTE)** extended valuable support for scientific conferences and environmental awareness initiatives. This partnership strengthened CEAD's efforts in promoting sustainable agriculture, environmental conservation, and science-based rural development.

13.1.7 Tamil Nadu Agricultural University (TNAU)

CEAD collaborated with **Tamil Nadu Agricultural University (TNAU)** through internship programmes and experiential learning activities for students of the **Agricultural College and Research Institute, Vazhavachanur**. The partnership enhanced students' practical knowledge and professional competencies in sustainable agriculture and rural development.

13.1.8 ICAR Scientists and Agricultural Experts

CEAD actively engaged with **ICAR scientists, faculty members, agricultural experts, and research professionals** as resource persons during conferences, technical sessions,

awareness programmes, and training activities. Their expertise significantly contributed to knowledge dissemination, technology transfer, and the promotion of sustainable agricultural practices.

13.1.9 PONDICHERRY UNIVERSITY

CEAD strengthened its collaboration with **Pondicherry University, Puducherry, India** through academic interactions, expert lectures, and capacity-building programmes. Faculty members and subject experts from the University participated as **Resource Persons** in conferences, awareness programmes, training programmes, and technical sessions organized by CEAD. Their valuable contributions enriched the scientific discussions, promoted knowledge sharing, and enhanced the quality of training provided to students, farmers, and community members. The collaboration further strengthened the linkage between higher education institutions and community-based agricultural extension initiatives, supporting CEAD's mission of promoting sustainable agriculture, environmental conservation, and rural development.

Impact of Partnerships

- Strengthened institutional collaboration for sustainable agriculture and environmental conservation.
- Enhanced technical capacity through expert-led training programmes and scientific conferences.
- Improved opportunities for student internships, experiential learning, and academic collaboration.
- Promoted research, innovation, and technology transfer for farming communities.
- Expanded outreach programmes benefiting farmers, students, women, youth, and rural stakeholders.
- Reinforced CEAD's role as a leading institution in agricultural extension, capacity building, and sustainable rural development.

14. FUTURE PLAN (2026–2027)

Building on the achievements of 2025–2026, the **Centre for Environment and Agricultural Development (CEAD)** is committed to expanding its programmes and strengthening its contribution to sustainable agriculture, environmental conservation, rural livelihoods, and community development. During **2026–2027**, CEAD will focus on innovative, inclusive, and climate-resilient initiatives that empower farmers, women, youth, students, and rural communities through education, training, research, and entrepreneurship.

14.1 Strategic Priorities for 2026–2027

14.1.1 Climate-Smart Agriculture

Promote climate-resilient farming practices, water-use efficiency, soil conservation, and sustainable natural resource management to improve agricultural productivity under changing climatic conditions.

14.1.2 Organic and Natural Farming Promotion

Expand awareness programmes and hands-on training on organic farming, natural farming, bio-input production, vermicomposting, and sustainable nutrient management to reduce dependence on chemical inputs.

14.1.3 Medicinal and Aromatic Plant Promotion

Strengthen the cultivation, conservation, and value addition of medicinal and aromatic plants through farmer training, demonstration plots, and collaboration with government agencies.

14.1.4 Farmer Capacity Building and Extension Services

Conduct regular training programmes, field demonstrations, exposure visits, and awareness campaigns to improve farmers' technical knowledge, productivity, and income.

14.1.5 Women and Youth Empowerment

Enhance livelihood opportunities for women Self-Help Groups (SHGs) and rural youth through entrepreneurship development, skill training, leadership programmes, and agri-business promotion.

14.1.6 Mushroom Cultivation and Value Addition

Organize specialized training programmes on mushroom cultivation, spawn production, processing, packaging, and marketing to encourage income-generating enterprises.

14.1.7 Vermicomposting and Organic Input Production

Expand training on vermicompost, vermiwash, biofertilizers, and organic waste management to promote sustainable soil health and environmental conservation.

14.1.8 Urban Agriculture and Nutrition Gardens

Promote terrace gardening, kitchen gardens, nutrition gardens, and microgreens production to improve household nutrition and encourage sustainable urban agriculture.

14.1.9 Student Internship and Experiential Learning

Strengthen collaborations with universities and colleges by expanding internship programmes, educational visits, research guidance, and practical skill development opportunities for students.

14.1.10 Research, Innovation, and Institutional Collaboration

Enhance partnerships with universities, research institutions, government departments, and development organizations to undertake collaborative research, technology transfer, scientific conferences, and community-based projects.

14.1.11 Digital Agriculture and Knowledge Dissemination

Promote the use of digital platforms, mobile-based advisory services, online training programmes, and information technology to improve agricultural extension and knowledge sharing.

14.1.12 Environmental Conservation and Sustainable Development

Implement programmes on biodiversity conservation, agroforestry, tree plantation, waste recycling, water conservation, and environmental awareness to support long-term ecological sustainability.

14.2 Our Commitment

CEAD remains dedicated to empowering communities through **sustainable agriculture, scientific knowledge, environmental stewardship, and inclusive rural development**. By strengthening partnerships, promoting innovation, and building local capacities, the organization will continue to create meaningful and lasting impacts for farmers, students, women, youth, and rural communities across the region.

15. Acknowledgement

The **Centre for Environment and Agricultural Development (CEAD)** expresses its sincere gratitude to all the individuals, institutions, and organizations whose invaluable support, guidance, and cooperation contributed to the successful implementation of our programmes and activities during **2025–2026**.

We extend our heartfelt appreciation to the **Government of Puducherry**, the **Department of Science, Technology & Environment (DSTE)**, the **Puducherry Council for Science and Technology (PCST)**, **National Institute of Agricultural Extension Management (MANAGE)**, **National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)**, and the **National Medicinal Plants Board (NMPB)**, **Ministry of AYUSH, Government of India**, for their continued encouragement and support towards our agricultural, environmental, and community development initiatives.

We gratefully acknowledge the valuable contributions of **Pondicherry Institute of Agricultural Sciences (PIAS)**, **Tamil Nadu Agricultural University (TNAU)**, **Pondicherry University**, **Vivekanandha Trust**, **ICAR Scientists**, university faculty members, agricultural experts, and resource persons who enriched our programmes through their knowledge, technical guidance, and professional expertise.

Our sincere thanks are extended to all **farmers, women Self-Help Groups (SHGs), students, internship trainees, volunteers, alumni, community members, and beneficiaries** whose active participation made every programme meaningful and successful. Their enthusiasm

and commitment continue to inspire our efforts towards sustainable agriculture and environmental conservation.

We also express our heartfelt gratitude to the **Chairman, Director, staff members, faculty, administrative personnel, volunteers, and organizing committees of CEAD** for their dedication, teamwork, and tireless efforts in planning and successfully implementing conferences, training programmes, awareness campaigns, extension activities, and community outreach initiatives throughout the year.

CEAD places on record its sincere appreciation to all our **partners, collaborators, sponsors, donors, and well-wishers** for their trust, encouragement, and continued support in advancing our shared mission of sustainable agricultural development and environmental stewardship.

As we look forward to another year of service, innovation, and collaboration, we reaffirm our commitment to empowering communities through education, research, capacity building, and sustainable development initiatives. Together, we will continue to create resilient farming systems, healthier environments, and stronger rural communities for future generations.



Together for Sustainable Agriculture and Environmental Development

"Growing Together • Learning Together • Sustaining Nature for Future Generations"

THANK YOU